

Workshop setup

Do this before the workshop, at home. Ten minutes, plus a download you should not leave until the last evening. Two things are involved: **the software** (a 2 GB download that unpacks to about 13 GB — you need **20 GB free disk space**) and **your folder** (about 10 MB). Docker does not know your folder exists until you start it from inside that folder.

Windows

1. Install Docker Desktop

docker.com/products/docker-desktop → install → restart when asked → launch it. Wait until the whale icon in the system tray stops animating.

2. Download your workshop folder

Download **flow-workshop-setup.zip** from the link in the workshop email. Right-click it → **Extract All** → extract to C:\Users\<you>\

You should end up with a folder at C:\Users\<you>\flow-workshop\. **Not** Documents, Desktop or OneDrive — those sync to the cloud, which breaks things.

3. Open a terminal there

Open the flow-workshop folder in File Explorer → click the address bar → type powershell → Enter.

4. Get the software

Good internet? Skip this step — step 5 downloads it for you.

From the USB stick: your file is **FOR-WINDOWS-AND-INTEL-MAC.tar.gz** (on a Snapdragon / ARM laptop, take FOR-APPLE-SILICON-MAC.tar.gz instead — same chip family).

Type `docker load -i` — with a space after the `i` — then **drag the file from File Explorer onto the PowerShell window**, which fills in the path for you. Press Enter. Do not type the path by hand.

A few minutes pass with no progress bar, then it prints `Loaded image: ghcr.io/victorrrwang/flow-workshop-r:2026.09`. To be sure, check Docker Desktop → **Images** — see the last page.

5. Start the container

```
docker compose up -d
```

The first time takes a while. When the prompt comes back it is running; later starts take seconds.

6. Check it works

Open **`http://localhost:8787`** — no password needed.

In the **Files** pane (bottom right): workshop → 00-check-your-setup.Rmd.

Run it: click **Knit** above the file (Ctrl+Shift+K), or **Run ► Run All** (Ctrl+Alt+R). Look for a line starting `SETUP OK` and **reply to the workshop email with it**. If it says anything else, send the whole output.

7. Stop it

`docker compose down` — your files stay. `docker compose up -d` starts it again anytime.

macOS

1. Install Docker Desktop

docker.com/products/docker-desktop → install → launch it from Applications. Wait until the whale icon in the menu bar stops animating.

Then: **Docker Desktop** → **Settings** → **Resources** → **Memory** → **8 GB** → **Apply & Restart**. The default is too small for this workshop.

2. Download your workshop folder

Download **flow-workshop-setup.zip** from the link in the workshop email. Safari usually unzips it for you; otherwise double-click it.

Drag the resulting **flow-workshop** folder into your home folder, so you end up with `/Users/<you>/flow-workshop/`. (In Finder, that is the one with the house icon — *Shift+Cmd+H* if you cannot see it.)

3. Open a terminal there

Open **Terminal** (Cmd+Space, type `terminal`, Enter). Type `cd` — with a space after it — then drag the `flow-workshop` folder from Finder onto the Terminal window and press Enter.

4. Get the software

Good internet? Skip this step — step 5 downloads it for you.

From the USB stick: which file depends on your Mac. Apple menu → **About This Mac** — “Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4” takes **FOR-APPLE-SILICON-MAC.tar.gz**, “Processor: Intel” takes **FOR-WINDOWS-AND-INTEL-MAC.tar.gz**.

Type `docker load -i` — with a space after the `i` — then **drag the file from Finder onto the Terminal window**, which fills in the path for you. Press Enter. Do not type the path by hand.

A few minutes pass with no progress bar, then it prints `Loaded image: ghcr.io/victorrrwang/flow-workshop-r:2026.09`. To be sure, check Docker Desktop → **Images** — see the last page.

5. Start the container

```
docker compose up -d
```

The first time takes a while. When the prompt comes back it is running; later starts take seconds.

6. Check it works

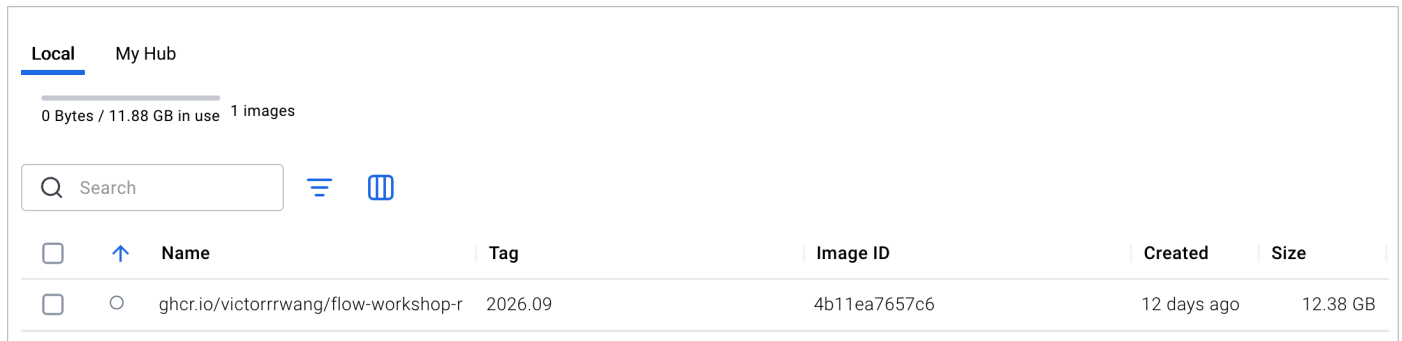
As Windows step 6 — open **`http://localhost:8787`**, run `workshop/00-check-your-setup.Rmd` from the **Files** pane — but the shortcuts are Cmd+Shift+K (Knit) and Cmd+Option+R (Run All). **Reply to the workshop email with the SETUP OK line**, or the whole output if it says anything else.

7. Stop it

`docker compose down` — your files stay. `docker compose up -d` starts it again anytime.

Did step 4 work?

Open Docker Desktop and click **Images** in the left sidebar. You are looking for one row named `ghcr.io/victorrrwang/flow-workshop-r`, tag `2026.09`, about 12 GB:



The screenshot shows the Docker Desktop 'Images' tab. At the top, there are tabs for 'Local' and 'My Hub'. Below them, a progress bar indicates '0 Bytes / 11.88 GB in use' and '1 images'. A search bar is present. Below the search bar is a table with columns: Name, Tag, Image ID, Created, and Size. One image is listed: 'ghcr.io/victorrrwang/flow-workshop-r' with tag '2026.09', Image ID '4b11ea7657c6', created '12 days ago', and size '12.38 GB'.

	Name	Tag	Image ID	Created	Size
☐	ghcr.io/victorrrwang/flow-workshop-r	2026.09	4b11ea7657c6	12 days ago	12.38 GB

If that row is there, the software is on your machine and you can go to step 5 — whatever scrolled past in the terminal.

If the list is **empty**, the docker load did not finish. The usual reasons:

- **Not enough disk space.** The file unpacks to about 13 GB. Free up space and run it again.
- **The path was typed by hand.** Drag the file onto the terminal window instead.
- **Docker Desktop was not running.** Start it, wait for the whale icon to settle, retry.

Running it again is safe — it does not damage anything and does not use double the space.

Stuck? Reply to the workshop email with a screenshot of what the terminal says. Please do not leave it until the morning.